

HARIAKSHA GUNDA

Curriculum Vitae

United States | hgunda@crimson.ua.edu | hariaksha.com

EDUCATION

The University of Alabama

B.S. IN DATA SCIENCE

Tuscaloosa, AL

08/2022 – 05/2027

- Minors: Mathematics, Computer Science, Economics
- Relevant Coursework: Development Economics, Non-Linear Optimization Theory, Real Analysis I-II, Machine Learning, Database Management Systems
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

The University of Alabama

B.A. IN FOREIGN LANGUAGES AND LITERATURE

Tuscaloosa, AL

08/2022 – 05/2027

- Concentration: German Language and Literature
- Minors: International Studies, Public Policy Studies, Global and Cultural Perspectives
- Relevant Coursework: Issues in Global Governance, Environmental Decision-Making, International Social Work, American Public Policy
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, UA Culverhouse College of Business

01/2024 – Present

Research Assistant, The University of Chicago

06/2026 – 07/2026

Visiting Researcher, Paderborn Research Center for Sustainable Economy

05/2025 - 08/2025

Data Scientist, Planet Indonesia International

12/2024 - 04/2025

Research Assistant, UA Digital Forensics and Cyber Security Lab

08/2023 - 12/2023

Data Scientist, Alabama Department of Public Health Center for Health Statistics

05/2023 - 06/2023

HONORS AND AWARDS

Ambassador, Institute for Economics and Peace

04/2026 – Present

Scholarship (7x, applied each semester), Zeta Psi Educational Foundation

01/2023 – 03/2026

REAL List: Global and Intercultural Learning Top 25, The University of Alabama

12/2025

Microsoft Emerging Leader, Microsoft Security

04/2025 – Present

Gilman Scholars Brussels EU Study Tour Selection, US Department of State

06/2025

National Award for Undergraduates of German, German National Honor Society

04/2025

Gilman Research Scholarship, US Department of State

12/2024 - 08/2025

Boren Scholarship, US Department of Defense

04/2024 - 04/2025

Outstanding Cultural Organization, UA (associated with South Asian Culture Club)

04/2024

Critical Language Scholarship, US Department of State (declined)

03/2024

Excellence Second-Year, University of Alabama German Department

04/2023

Best Event Award, UA (associated with South Asian Culture Club Mock Shaadi)

04/2023

Children of Associates Premier Scholarship (3x), H&R Block

09/2022 – 09/2023

Crimson Scholar, The University of Alabama

08/2022 – 05/2024

National Merit Finalist Scholarship, National Merit Scholarship Corporation

04/2022

PRESENTATIONS

Oral Presentations

Paderborn Research Center for Sustainable Economy Brown Bag Seminar. August 2025. *The Economics of Data Privacy: Regulatory Uncertainty and Corporate Responses to the EU GDPR*

Planet Indonesia International Intern Symposium. April 2025. *Marine Environmental Risk Assessments for Indonesian Provinces using Data on Ecology and Socio-economic and Environmental Resilience*

State University of Malang Student Seminars. December 2024. *Assessment of Marine Environmental Risks in Indonesia*

Poster Presentations

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. April 2026. *The Heat Is On: Causal Impacts of Wildfires on Conflict Probability and Intensity in Indonesia*

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. April 2026. *The Economics of Data Privacy: Regulatory Uncertainty and Corporate Responses to the EU GDPR*

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. March 2024. *The Impact of Linguistic Features on Revenues using NLP on Mission Statements of Tax-Exempt Organizations*

CERTIFICATIONS AND SPECIAL LEARNING

Documenting Development Data Using Metadata Standards , The World Bank Group	08/2026
Responsible AI in a Global Context , United Nations University	07/2026
How Tech Drives Sustainability , LinkedIn Learning	06/2026
IEP Ambassador Seminars , Institute for Economics and Peace	05/2026
Positive Peace Academy , Institute for Economics and Peace	02/2026
Microsoft Emerging Leader Professional Development Series , Microsoft Security	08/2025
Climate Catalysts Mentorship Program , UNFCCC	05/2025
Becoming a Climate Champion , UNITAR	04/2025
Digital4Sustainability Learning Path , UNSSC	03/2025
Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification , DeepLearning.AI	02/2025
AI For Everyone , DeepLearning.AI	01/2024
Cybersecurity Foundations Specialization , InfoSEC	05/2023
Python Essential Training , LinkedIn Learning	11/2022

PROJECTS

The University of Alabama CO-INVESTIGATOR WITH DR. MICHAEL PRICE Causal Impacts of Wildfires on Social Unrest in Indonesia	01/2026 – Present <i>Working Paper</i>
The University of Chicago, The University of Alabama, The University of Toronto Present RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO DR. JOHN LIST, DR. MICHAEL PRICE, AND DR. ANGELA DOKU Sentiment Analysis of Climate Disaster News Articles in the USA	10/2025 – <i>Working Paper</i>
The University of Alabama RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO DR. MICHAEL PRICE Impact of Mission Statement Linguistic Features on Nonprofit Revenues	01/2024 – 05/2024 <i>No longer active</i>
ZEW Mannheim, The University of Alabama RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO DR. MARTIN KESTERNICH AND DR. MICHAEL PRICE The Effects of GDPR on Firm Behavior and Innovation	05/2025 – 08/2025 <i>No longer active</i>
Planet Indonesia International DATA SCIENTIST WITH ADAM MILLER Marine Environmental Risk Assessments for Indonesian Provinces	12/2024 – 04/2025 <i>Completed</i>

EXTRACURRICULARS AND AFFILIATIONS

Research Ambassador , UA Office of Undergraduate Research	04/2026 – 05/2027
Member , Blue Key Honor Society	04/2026 – Present
Member , Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society	04/2026 – Present
Member , Pi Mu Epsilon, the National Honor Society for Mathematics	04/2026 – Present
Member , UA Philomathic Literary Society	03/2026 – 05/2027
Member , UA Education Abroad Alumni Association	03/2026 – Present

President , United Nations Association of the USA at UA	08/2025 – 05/2026
Technology Mechanisms Working Group Member , UNFCCC YOUNGO	06/2025 – Present
Member , United Nations Association of the USA	06/2025 – 06/2026
Member , Asian Environmental Youth Network	06/2025 – Present
Data Volunteer , Oxford Net Zero Tracker	05/2025 – Present
Member , Delta Phi Alpha (German National Honor Society)	05/2024 – Present
Member , National Security Education Program (NSEP) Alumni Association	05/2024 – Present
Honors College Ambassador , UA Honors College	03/2024 – 05/2027
Scholarship Officer , Zeta Psi International Fraternity	01/2023 – 05/2027
Member , Golden Key Honor Society	09/2022 – Present
Secretary & Advisor , UA South Asian Culture Club	08/2022 – 05/2027
Member , Association for Computing Machinery	08/2022 – Present
Member , Society of Asian Scientists and Engineers	08/2022 – Present
Member , UA German Club	08/2022 – 05/2027
Choreographer, Teacher, Dancer , Nach Basanti (Indian fusion dance team)	08/2022 – 05/2027

FEATURED

Podcasts

Put the Guidebook Down. April 2026. *Speaking the Place: How Language Changes the Way You Travel*

Put the Guidebook Down. December 2025. *The Power of a Gap Year: Breaking Out of the Linear Life Path*

Datasets

Oxford Net Zero Tracker. September 2025. *Net Zero Stocktake 2025*

SKILLS

Technical Skills: Python, Econometrics, Field Experiments, R, SQL, MATLAB, TensorFlow, Webscraping, Database Management, Git, HTML/CSS/JS, LaTeX, Stata, QGIS

Languages: *German* (CEFR B1: Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Indonesian* (ACTFL 2: Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Malay* (Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Telugu* (Basic)